



Matobev

Product & Design Document

What the product is, every screen it contains, an honest assessment of its current design, and a proposed visual system built from the logo outward.

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Scope 42 screens · player and scout roles

Date 20 August 2026

Status Pre-launch, Android build passing

What Matobev is

Matobev is a talent-discovery platform for African footballers. A player uploads a highlight video from their phone; software analyses how they move and produces a rating; scouts search, watch, shortlist and make contact.

The problem it addresses

Talent in African football is abundant and badly distributed. A gifted seventeen-year-old in Kisumu is not short of ability — they are short of *anyone credible seeing them play*. Discovery runs on physical presence and personal networks: being at the right academy, knowing someone, being able to travel to a trial. Each of those is a filter on circumstance rather than on ability.

That vacuum is filled by exploitation. Fake agents charge families for trials that do not exist, for "registration fees", for travel that never happens. It is one of the most reliable ways to take money from a family that has very little, because the thing being sold — hope — is the one thing they will pay for.

THE PRODUCT'S CORE BET

If a player can be seen and assessed from a phone video, then discovery stops depending on geography and connections. The rating is not the product. **Being visible to someone real is the product.** The rating is the mechanism that makes a stranger worth a scout's attention.

Who it serves

Role	Wants	Gets
Player 13+, mostly 15–21	To be seen by someone who can change their situation	A profile, a rating, a route to scouts and open trials, and evidence anyone is looking
Scout clubs, academies, agents	To find players worth a journey, without watching a thousand videos	Filtered search, ratings as a first pass, shortlists, notes, direct contact, trial posting

What makes it different

Not the analysis — the honesty about it. The engine currently measures a handful of attributes and is frequently unsure. Rather than hiding that behind a confident number, the app states it: every score

carries a confidence, low-confidence values are visibly marked, and the overall rating is weighted so an uncertain measurement counts for less.

WHY THIS IS THE WHOLE STRATEGY

Ratings drive real decisions about young people who have very little. A confident number that is wrong sends a scout on a wasted journey and tells a teenager something false about themselves. On a scale users read fluently from football games — where 99 is world class — an unqualified **16** is not a statistic, it is a verdict. The platform's long-term credibility with scouts rests entirely on never having overstated what it knows.

How a player moves through it

1. **Arrive** — browse real players before signing up; no wall in front of the value.
2. **Register** — four required fields only: name, date of birth, nationality, position.
3. **Upload** — a highlight from the camera roll, tagging themselves in one frame.
4. **Get rated** — analysis runs; the result arrives with its confidence attached.
5. **Be seen** — appear in scout search and on the improvement leaderboard.
6. **Return** — because a scout viewed the profile, the rating moved, or the week had something in it.

How a scout moves through it

1. **Verify** — submit credentials; unverified accounts see less.
2. **Set preferences** — positions, countries, age range, minimum rating.
3. **Discover** — recommendations built from those preferences and real activity, never a fabricated reason.
4. **Assess** — open a profile, watch the footage, read the attribute breakdown and its confidence.
5. **Shortlist** — save to folders, add private notes, compare side by side.
6. **Act** — message the player, or post a trial and receive applications.

Every screen

Forty-two screens across five groups. Entry and onboarding, the player's five tabs, the scout's five tabs, shared destinations both roles reach, and settings.

Entry & onboarding — 9 screens

Index index

Routing gate. Decides between welcome, onboarding, profile completion, or the correct tab set based on session and role.

Welcome welcome

First screen for a signed-out visitor. Sign in, create an account, or browse without an account.

Onboarding onboarding

Three slides explaining upload → analysis → scouts. Ends with the same signed-out browse route.

Browse browse

Signed-out player list. Adults only — under-18 profiles are excluded at the database level, not merely hidden in the UI. Any action prompts sign-up with a reason naming the action.

Role select role-select

Player or scout. Deliberately irreversible — the role is immutable in the database, because switching would expose the other side of the platform.

Sign up signup

Email, password, and acceptance of the Terms and Privacy Policy — both of which open in an in-app browser so reading them does not interrupt registration.

Log in login

Email and password, with a route to recovery.

Forgot password forgot-password

Email-based reset.

Verify email verify-email

Post-registration hold with a resend option.

Profile completion profile-complete

The four required fields plus optional detail. Enforces the minimum age of 13 and flags under-18 accounts for guardian consent.

Player tabs — 5 screens

Home (player-tabs)/home

The rating card as hero, an upload prompt, three quick actions, upcoming trials and recent activity. The first screen on every launch.

Reels (player-tabs)/reels

Full-screen vertical video feed of other players' highlights, with like, save, comment and share.

Upload (player-tabs)/upload

Pick a clip, choose highlight-only or AI analysis, tag yourself in one frame, add metadata. Size is checked before transfer, and under-18s without guardian consent are stopped before a byte is uploaded.

Discover (player-tabs)/discover

Search and filter other players; trending list; news.

Profile (player-tabs)/profile

Own profile with About, Videos, AI Ratings and Stats tabs, plus a profile-strength meter.

Scout tabs — 5 screens

Dashboard (scout-tabs)/home

Verification state, search, scouting overview, and four rails: Recommended, Recently Uploaded, Top Performers, Active Trials. Recommendations carry a real reason drawn from preferences and activity.

Players (scout-tabs)/players

The main search surface — filters, sorting, compare mode.

Trials (scout-tabs)/trials

Create and manage trials; review applicants.

Messages (scout-tabs)/messages

Conversations with players, carrying the anti-solicitation safety notice.

Profile (scout-tabs)/profile

Organisation, bio, verification status, saved-player statistics.

Shared destinations — 11 screens

Player detail player/[id]

The scout's assessment surface: cover, overall rating with confidence, attribute bars, playable videos, save-to-folder, private notes, follow, message, report.

Compare compare

Two or more players side by side. The per-attribute "best" highlight is withheld when the winning value is low-confidence — the app declines to assert a comparison it cannot support.

AI ratings ai-ratings

Full breakdown: every attribute, its value, its confidence, and analysis-job status.

Leaderboard leaderboard

Segmented so most users can place. Players see Most improved, region, position, age band; scouts see Most improved, Top rated, and matches for their own filters.

Trials list / Trial detail trials · trial/[id]

Open trials, requirements, deadlines, and application flow.

Messages / Notifications messages · notifications

Player-side inbox, and the notification feed — every entry routes to what it is about.

News news

Announcements and platform updates.

Guardian consent guardian-consent

Where an under-18 sends a parent a link to approve AI analysis. Confirmation happens on a web page the guardian opens — never with a checkbox inside the child's own app.

Scout verification scout-verification

Document upload and review status.

Suspended suspended

Terminal state with the reason and an appeal route.

Settings — 9 screens

Settings hub settings

Account, security, notifications, privacy, blocked accounts, language, theme, help — and, for under-18 players, the guardian screen.

Account · Security · Privacy account- · security- · privacy-settings

Details, password, visibility, and immediate account deletion.

Notifications notification-settings

Per-category mutes and quiet hours in local time.

Blocked accounts blocked-accounts

Blocking is enforced in row-level security, so a blocked party cannot read the other's rows at all.

Language · Theme · Help language- · theme- · help-settings

English, French, Swahili, Portuguese; light/dark/system; FAQ, safety notice, support, and the legal documents.

How I would design it

The architecture is strong. The visual identity is not yet an identity — it is a set of reasonable defaults that do not agree with each other.

The central problem: the logo and the app are different brands

The logo is a **teal-to-navy** mark. The app is built on **electric blue** with a gold accent. Measured from the logo's own pixels against the app's tokens:

Element	Colour	Hue	Where it lives
Logo — dominant	#00A0B0	185°	The mark, everywhere it appears
Logo — ground	#002040	210°	The mark's dark figures
App primary	#1A6DFF	218°	Every button, link and active state
App accent	#FFD54F	46°	Ratings, highlights

WHY 33 DEGREES IS THE WORST POSSIBLE DISTANCE

Teal at 185° and blue at 218° are **close enough to read as a mistake and far enough apart to clash**. If they were identical they would be coherent; if they were opposite they would be a deliberate pairing. Sitting a third of the way between reads as two people who never spoke. Every screen in the app currently argues with its own logo.

The direction: build outward from the mark

The logo is the one asset that will not change, so it should decide the palette rather than be decorated around. That gives three moves:

- **Teal becomes primary.** Buttons, links, active states, focus rings — everything currently electric blue.
- **Navy becomes the dark ground and the ink.** It already is in the logo; it should be the app's darkest surface and its heading colour.
- **Gold stays, and gets a job.** Teal at 186° and gold at 46° are near-complementary — they reinforce rather than compete. Gold should mean exactly one thing: *achievement*. Ratings, leaderboard positions, milestones. Nothing else.

What each colour is allowed to mean

The current palette's real weakness is not the hues, it is that blue means six different things — primary action, link, active tab, information, selection, and brand. When one colour means everything it means nothing, and users stop reading it as a signal.

Colour	Means exactly	Never used for
Teal	Something you can do, or where you are	Status, achievement, decoration
Gold	Something earned — a rating, a rank, a milestone	Buttons, warnings, links
Navy	Structure — headings, dark surfaces, the card ground	Interactive elements
Green / Red	Outcome — succeeded, failed, blocked	Anything not an outcome
Grey	Present but secondary, including low confidence	Disabled-only meaning

Four principles I would hold the design to

1. Depth must survive dark mode

Shadows are invisible on a dark ground, so hierarchy there has to come from lighter surfaces. The rule is simple and must be verified numerically rather than by eye: **every level of the stack must be measurably lighter than the one beneath it**. Hex codes do not sort by perceived lightness, and this exact ordering has been silently inverted twice in this codebase already.

2. Uncertainty is a visual property, not a footnote

A low-confidence rating should look different from a confident one at a glance — muted, marked, and never eligible to win a comparison. This is the product's differentiator and it belongs in the type and colour system, not in help text nobody opens.

3. One celebratory moment, and only one

The arrival of a rating is the emotional peak. That is where motion, haptics and gold belong. Everywhere else should be quiet, because an app that celebrates constantly celebrates nothing — and because these users are on budget Android hardware where animation costs frames.

4. Designed for the actual device and hand

Mid-range Android, outdoors, in sunlight, often one-handed, frequently on metered data. That argues for higher contrast than a design system default, a 17px body minimum, primary actions in the lower half of the screen, and never spending a megabyte before telling the user what it will cost.

The colour system

Every value below is measured, not chosen by eye. Contrast ratios are against the surface each colour actually sits on.

Brand — taken from the logo



Navy

#002040

Ink, headings, darkest surface, card ground



Teal — primary

#00808F

Buttons, links, active states



Teal — logo

#00A0B0

The mark only. Too light for text.



Teal — dark mode

#3FC7D6

Primary on dark surfaces



Gold

#FFD54F

Ratings and rank, on dark only



Gold — on light

#8A5A00

Ratings on a light card

Pairing	Ratio	Verdict
Teal #00808F on white	4.68 : 1	Passes AA for text and as a button fill
Logo teal #00A0B0 on white	3.16 : 1	Fails. Use for the mark, never for text
Teal #3FC7D6 on dark #111A2B	8.58 : 1	Passes comfortably
Gold #FFD54F on navy #002040	11.62 : 1	Excellent — the rating numeral pairing
Gold #FFD54F on white	1.23 : 1	Invisible. Gold on light must darken to #8A5A00
Navy #002040 on white	16.40 : 1	The heading pairing

THE TRAP WORTH NAMING

Contrast is symmetric — white-on-teal and teal-on-white are necessarily the same ratio. The distinction that actually matters is *which surface*, not which is foreground: a colour that works on white will usually fail on navy, and the reverse. Gold is the clearest case in this palette — **11.62 : 1 on navy and 1.23 : 1 on white**, the same colour, unusable in one of them.

Surfaces — an ordered stack

Level	Light	Dark	Used for
Page	#EEF1F6	#070E1B	Behind everything
Recessed	#F4F7FA	#0F1729	Chips, inputs, tracks
Surface	#FFFFFF	#131B2E	Default card
Raised	shadow	#161F30	List cards, quick actions
Floating	shadow	#1B2537	The rating card
Overlay	shadow	#1F2A3E	Sheets, modals, menus

In light mode depth is a shadow; in dark mode it is a lighter surface plus a hairline. Same API either way, so no screen branches on theme — and the ordering is machine-checked, because it has been wrong before.

Typography

Role	Face	Size	Notes
Rating numeral	Poppins ExtraBold	52	Tight tracking; the hero of the card
Screen title	Poppins Bold	22–26	
Section heading	Poppins SemiBold	17–18	
Body	Poppins Regular	15	Never below 15 for reading text
Caption	Poppins Medium	10	The floor. Nothing smaller exists.

One family, five weights. A second face would cost a download on a metered connection and buy nothing a weight change cannot.

Proposed screens

Four screens in the proposed system. Teal carries action, gold carries achievement, navy carries structure, and uncertainty is visible.



Left — Player home. The rating card is navy with a gold numeral: the one place gold appears, so it always means achievement. Teal carries the upload action. The middot after 25 and the muted 1 · PAC mark low-confidence values at a glance.

Centre — Scout player detail. Confidence is stated in words as well as colour, because green/amber/red alone excludes red-green colour-blind viewers — around 8% of a scout population that skews male. Footage is prominent and playable; Message is the single teal action.

Right — Leaderboard, Most improved. The default board, because rating-sorted lists tell most users they are nowhere. Gains in green, ratings in teal, gold reserved for first place.

What I would change first

#	Change	Why it is first
1	Swap primary blue for logo teal	One token change removes the brand incoherence across all 42 screens
2	Restrict gold to achievement only	Gives the rating a colour nothing else may borrow
3	Rating card to navy in both themes	Anchors the hero to the mark, and gold only works on a dark ground
4	Confidence in words, not colour alone	Accessibility, and it is the product's differentiator
5	Walk both roles end to end on a device	Three defects were found this way in ninety seconds; there will be more

THE HONEST ASSESSMENT

Matobev looks like a real app that has not been used yet. The engineering is genuinely strong — access control enforced in the database, no fabricated data anywhere, confidence surfaced rather than hidden, real child-safety controls. But until this week a scout could not play a player's video, the back button vanished on a light photo, and the leaderboard offered scouts a filter on a position they do not have. None of those are subtle; all three survived because the app was verified by typechecks and bundles rather than by someone using it as a scout. **The gap is not polish or architecture. It is that nobody has walked each role end to end.**